SB20 World Championship 2026

16 – 23 October 2026
Hyères, France

Organizing Authority
COYCH

Sailing Instructions
(SI)

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16-23 October 2026 / Hyères
Sailing Instructions

1. RULES

The event will be governed by the rules as defined in The Racing Rules of Sailing 2025-2028 (RRS).

1.1. RRS Appendix T Arbitration will apply.

1.2. Equipment Rules of Sailing, 2025-2028 (ERS),

1.3. Equipment Inspection Regulations (EIR).

1.4. Appendix P applies with the following changes:

1.4.1 RRS P1.2 is changed as follows:

P1.2 If an observer appointed under rule P1.1 decides that a boat has broken rule 42 or SB20 Class Rules C3.3 (Positioning) or C.9.8(a)(1) (Bowsprit. Use), the boat may be penalized by, as soon as reasonably possible making a sound signal, pointing a yellow flag at her, and clearly identifying her by hailing, even if she is no longer racing. A boat so penalized shall not be penalized a second time under the same rule for the same incident.

1.4.2 RRS P2.1 is changed as follows:

P2.1 Penalties

When a boat is penalized under rule P1.2 her penalty shall take One-Turn Penalty under rule 44.2. If she fails to take it she shall be disqualified without a hearing.

1.4.3 RRS P2.2 and P2.3 do not apply.

2. CHANGES TO SAILING INSTRUCTIONS

2.1. Any change to the Sailing Instructions will be posted no later than two hours before the first scheduled race on the day it will take effect, except that any change to the schedule of races will be posted by 20:00 on the day before it will take effect.

3. COMMUNICATION WITH COMPETITORS

3.1. The official notice board is on-line at : www.sb20worldshyeres2026.com/ONB/RRS. The QR code and direct link to access the official notice board is available in the Addendum B.

3.2. The VHF Channel to be used for the race committee broadcasts is channel 69.

3.3. The Event Messaging System for this event will be setup using Whatsapp. The QR code to join the group is available in the Addendum B. Messages in the Whatsapp Group are a courtesy and will not replace an official communication made on the official notice board. Failure to send these messages will not be grounds for redress. This changes RRS 61.4(b)(1).

3.4. The Race Office is located at Espace Nautique Hyerois (1st floor)

3.5. On the water, the Race Committee may broadcast information available to all competitors on VHF radio channel 69, including starting and safety information. Failure to make broadcasts will not be grounds for redress. This changes RRS 61.4(b)(1).

3.6. While racing, except in an emergency, a boat shall not make voice or data transmissions and shall not receive voice or data communication that is not available to all boats.

3.7. Competitors and support persons may listen to the voice/video recording(s) and review the written records of their finishes. For this purpose, the race officer will be available in the race office until the end of the protest time limit.

3.8. The first skippers briefing will be held on the 18th October at 18:00. From 20th October, there will be a daily skippers briefing at 10:30. Location of the daily skippers briefing area will be posted up on the ONB. See the schedule in SI 6.1.

4. CODE OF CONDUCT

4.1. Competitors and support persons shall comply with reasonable requests from race officials.

4.2. Competitors and support persons shall handle any equipment or place advertising provided by the organizing authority with care, seamanship, in accordance with any instructions for its use and without interfering with its functionality.

5. SIGNALS MADE ASHORE

5.1. Signals made ashore will be displayed from the Base Nautique flagpole.

5.2. When AP is displayed ashore, '1 minute' is replaced with 'not less than (thirty) '30 minutes' in the race signal AP. This changes RRS Race Signals.

6. SCHEDULE

6.1. **The event schedule will be as follows:**

Date	*Time*	*Activity*	*Venue*
Friday 16 and Saturday 17 October	09h00 – 18h00	Arrival, Registration and Equipment Inspection	Espace Nautique Hyères Base Nautique Hyères
Sunday, 18 October	09h00 – 18h00	Registration and Equipment Inspection	Espace Nautique Hyères Base Nautique Hyères
	14h00	First possible warning signal - Practice Race	Race area
	18h00 18h30	Skippers Briefing Opening Ceremony	Espace Nautique Hyères
Monday, 19 October			
	12h00	First possible warning signal - World Championship	Race area
Tuesday, 20 October	10h30	Skippers Briefing	Espace Nautique Hyères
	12h00	First possible warning signal - World Championship	Race area
Wednesday, 21 October	10h30	Skippers Briefing	Espace Nautique Hyères
	12h00	First possible warning signal - World Championship	Race area
Thursday, 22 October	10h30	Skippers Briefing	Espace Nautique Hyères
	12h00	First possible warning signal - World Championship	Race area
Friday,	9h30	Skippers Briefing	Espace Nautique Hyères

23 October			
	11h00	First possible warning signal - World Championship	Race area
	18h00	Closing ceremony / Prize presentation	Espace Nautique Hyères
Saturday, 24 October		Packing and Departure	Base Nautique Hyères

6.2. Thirteen (13) races are scheduled for the SB20 World Championships 2026.

6.3. The RC may race as many as three (3) races each day.

6.4. If in the opinion of RC the Event is behind schedule or likely to fall behind schedule, four (4) races may be raced on one day.

6.5. After a long postponement, or to alert boats that a race or sequence of races will begin soon, an orange flag will be displayed with one sound, at least two minutes before a warning signal is displayed.

7. CLASS FLAG

7.1. The Class Flag will be the SB20 Class logo on a white background.

8. COURSES

8.1. The diagram in SI Addendum A shows the course, including the approximate angles between legs, the order in which marks are to be passed, and the side on which each mark is to be left.

9. MARKS

9.1. Marks are described in Addendum A.

9.2. A vessel that is a mark may not be anchored, but held in place by the use of an engine. This will not be grounds for request of redress, provided the vessel remains close to her correct position. This changes RRS 61.4(b)(1).

10. THE START

10.1. The starting line is between staffs displaying orange flags on the starting marks or between a staff displaying an orange flag on the starting boat and the course side of a mark (described in Addendum A) at the port end of the line.

10.2. A buoy may be attached to the race committee starting vessel anchor line just below keel depth. Boats shall not pass between this buoy and the race committee starting vessel at any time. This buoy is part of the race committee starting vessel ground tackle.

10.3. A boat that does not start within four (4) minutes after her starting signal will be scored Did Not Start (DNS) without a hearing. This changes RRS A5.1 and A5.2.

11. CHANGE OF COURSE

11.1. To change the next leg of the course, the Race Committee may (a) lay a new mark, (b) move the finishing line, or (c) move the leeward gate. When a new mark is laid, the original mark will be removed as soon as possible.

11.2. If a change of course is signalled and mark 1 is replaced, mark 1P and 1A may not be laid.

11.3. Except at a gate, boats shall pass between the Race Committee vessel signalling the change of the next leg and the nearby mark, leaving the mark to port and the Race Committee vessel to starboard.

12. THE FINISH

12.1. The finishing line will be between the staff displaying blue flag and the finishing mark (described in Addendum A) on the port side of the line.

13. PENALTY SYSTEM

13.1. When after a hearing the International Jury decides that a boat that is a party to a protest hearing has broken a rule other than a rule of RRS Part1, Part 2 or rules 28 or 31, it may impose penalties other than disqualification.

13.2. A party to a protest hearing may request an arbitration meeting under RRS Appendix T no later than 15 minutes before the scheduled hearing time for her case. The arbitration meeting will be held provided all parties agree and attend the meeting.

13.3. The Umpire Observation System described in Addendum C will apply.

14. TIME LIMITS AND TARGET TIME

14.1. The time limits and target times are as follows:

Time Limit (1) **For 1st boat to finish as RRS 35.**	**Time limit (2)** **Latest time to finish after 1st boat sails the course and finishes.**	**Target Finish Time**
70 minutes	20 minutes	45 minutes

14.2. Boats that do not finish within time limit (2) will be scored DNF without a hearing. This changes RRS 35, A5.1 and A5.2.

14.3. Failure to meet the Target Finish Time will not be grounds for redress. This changes RRS 61.4(b)(1).

15. HEARING REQUESTS

15.1. A boat intending to request a hearing shall inform the race committee at the finishing line. If the boat does not finish the race, she shall inform the Race Office as soon as possible after coming ashore.

15.2. The protest time limit for incidents observed in the racing area 60 minutes after the last boat has finished the last race of the day or the Race Committee signals no more racing today, whichever is later.

15.3. Hearing requests shall be submitted using Racing Rules of Sailing on-line system. A request button will be available on the notice board.

15.4. Notices will be posted on the official notice board no later than 30 minutes after the protest time limit to inform competitors of hearings in which they are parties or named as witnesses. Hearings will be held at Base Nautique (1st floor) Jury Room and the location of the hearing room will be announced on the ONB.

15.5. Courtesy messages regarding hearings may be sent via the Event Messaging System. Failure to send this message will not be grounds for redress nor will be an excuse for a party to not attend a hearing. (This changes RRS 61.4(b)(1).

16. SCORING

16.1. Three (3) races are required to be completed to constitute a series.

16.2. Scoring shall be according to the Low Point Scoring System changing RRS A2 and A4 as follows:

- When fewer than five (5) races have been completed, a boat's series score will be the total of her race scores.
- When five (5) or more races have been completed, a boat's series score will be the total of her race scores excluding her worst score.

17. GPS TRACKING DEVICES [NP] [DP]

17.1. All boats shall have picked up their GPS Tracking Device at the Race Office before 18h00 Sunday, August 18th. Tracking devices shall be on board each day, from the moment the boat leaves the harbour to get to the racing area until the end of the day. Each crew will keep the device until the end of the Championship and will hand it back to the race office within the protest time limit on Friday 23rd. No need to turn on or off, it's done by Metasails. The crew shall not turn off the tracking device nor take any action to reduce its effectiveness

18. SAFETY REGULATIONS

18.1. See the Notice of Race Addendum C for specific STR safety regulations.
All boats, whilst afloat, preparing to go afloat and on return to shore shall comply with instructions given by slipway marshals and any race official committee vessel or patrol vessel.

19. REPLACEMENT OF CREW OR EQUIPMENT

19.1. Substitution of competitors shall be made in accordance to Class Rule C3.2 (b) and is not allowed without prior written approval of the race committee.

19.2. Competitors desiring to substitute crew shall have new crew members weighed-in half an hour before the morning briefing on the day the new crew member will sail. If it is necessary to substitute a crew member in between races, the race committee may authorise the change subject to confirmation of the weigh compliance when the boat returns ashore after racing that day.

19.3. Substitution of damaged or lost equipment is not allowed unless authorized in writing by the Technical Committee. Requests for substitution shall be made to the committee at the first reasonable opportunity, which may be after the race.

20. EQUIPMENT AND MEASUREMENT CHECKS

20.1. Each boat shall produce at Registration evidence of insurance cover as per NOR 19.

20.2. A boat or equipment may be inspected at any time for compliance with the Class Rules, ERS, EIR and SI.

20.3. On the water, a boat may be instructed by a race official to proceed immediately to a designated area for inspection. Such a boat shall proceed to the designated area as soon as possible.

20.4. Boat and equipment may be inspected at any time by the Technical Committee both on the water or onshore.

21. OFFICIAL VESSELS

21.1. Official vessels will be marked with white flags carrying black letters as follows:

Boat	Flag / Letters
Race Committee boat	COYCH Flag

Mark boat	No flag
Umpire	Yellow Flag with JURY blue
Media	MEDIA Flag
Safety	COYCH Flag

22. SUPPORT TEAMS

22.1. Team leaders, coaches and other support persons shall stay outside areas where boats are racing from the time of the preparatory signal until all boats have finished or retired or the race committee signals a postponement, general recall, or abandonment.

23. IDENTIFICATION [NP]

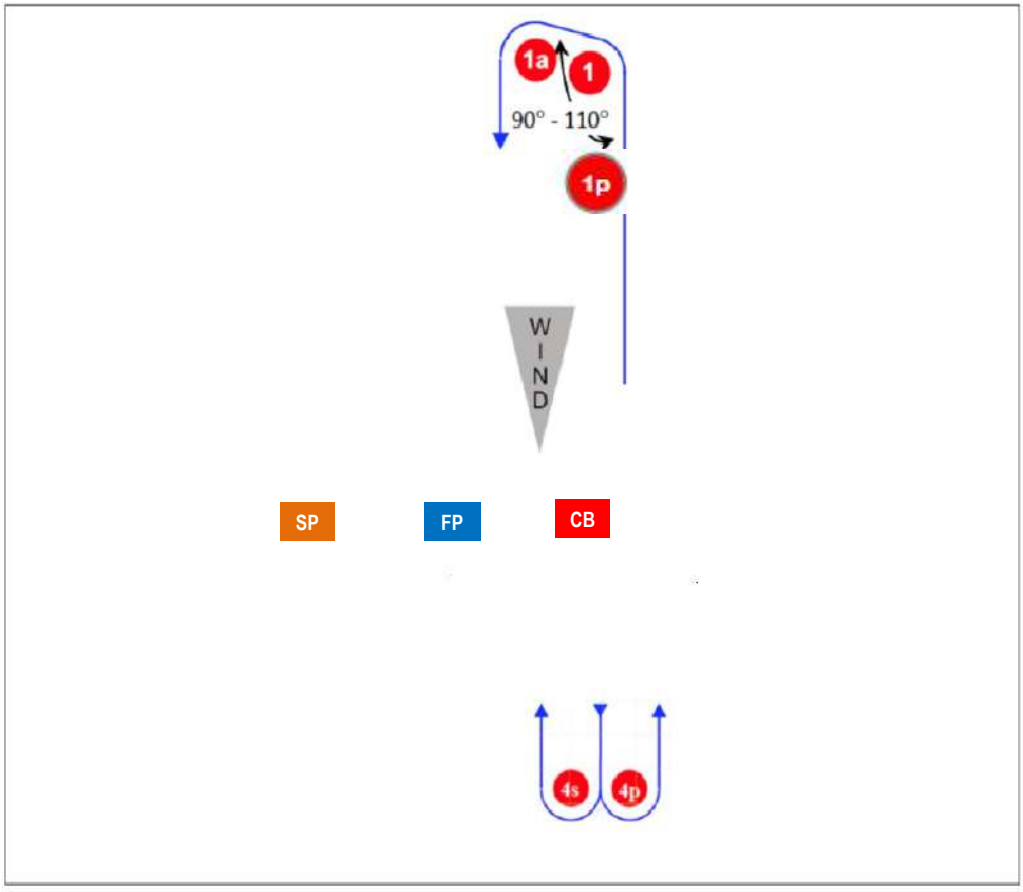
23.1. Provided two or more races have been completed, from Tuesday, October 21th onwards, each day while racing, the sailors of the first, second and third boats in series ranking at the beginning of the day shall wear yellow, blue, and red bibs respectively. These bibs will be available each day at the morning briefing of the day and shall be returned by competitors as soon as possible after the day's racing.

ADDENDUM A
Marks & Courses

A.1 THE RACE COURSE

A.1.1 The race courses are depicted on the below diagram.

CB	Committee Boat – Start / Finish
SP	Start port side – vessel / mark
FP	Finish port side - mark



Signal	Orders in which marks are to be passed
No Signal Displayed	Start - 1p - 1 - 1a - 4s/4p - 1p - 1 - 1a - 4s/4p - Finish

A.1.2 The distance of legs, the colour of marks and the angle between marks may not be as shown.

A.2 MARKS

The following marks will be used:

Name	Description of Mark:	Mark Colour
Mark 1	Cylindrical	Orange
Mark 1a	Cylindrical	Orange
Mark 1p	Cylndrical	Yellow sigled TPM
Gate 4p	Cylindrical	Orange
Gate 4s	Cylindrical	Orange
Finish Mark FP	Tube	Yellow
Change of course Mark	Cylindrical	Green sigled « Ville de Hyères »

If only one of the Gate marks is laid, boats shall leave it to port.

A3. OBSTRUCTIONS

The finishing line is an obstruction for boats sailing on the downwind leg. Boats sailing to the leeward gate shall not cross the finishing line from the direction of the windward mark.

ADDENDUM B
Event Links

B1 OFFICIAL NOTICE BOARD

Notice: The Official Notice Board (ONB) is still the only official source of information for this regatta.

Actions

Competitor | **Scoring Inquiry** | **Request for Hearing** | **Contact (non-competitor)**

NOTICE: When submitting a protest, request or report, the procedure (as set forth in the Racing Rules of Sailing and the Sailing Instructions) remains unchanged.

Race Operations

Online Notice Board | **Scoring Inquiries** | **Hearing Schedule** | **Hearing Decisions**

The jury and parties reserve the right to limit public access to certain decisions.*

B2 EVENT MESSAGING SYSTEM

Following link can be used to join Event Messaging System:

https://chat.whatsapp.com/LSJTIsmJHbN6QhMBDQNeda

SB20 World Championship HYERES 2026 Official
Groupe WhatsApp

ADDENDUM C
Umpire Observation

C.1 Umpires may observe the racing and provide advisory umpire signals. If an umpire observes an incident where a boat protests, one of the following signals may be made:

< 20cm >

(a) A green and white flag with one long sound means 'The umpires saw the incident and believe that no rule was broken'.

(b) A red flag with one long sound means 'The umpires saw the incident and believe that one or more boat has broken a rule'. The umpires will hail or signal each boat identified to have broken a rule.

(c) A "J" flag with one long sound means 'The umpires do not have the facts to make a decision'.

C.2 The signals displayed by the umpires are for information only. If a red flag is displayed, any identified boat is not obliged to take the applicable penalty, however if she does not, the Umpire, as part of the protest committee, may protest that boat. If a green and white flag or the "J" flag is displayed, a boat may still protest, or a boat may choose to take the applicable penalty.

C.3 If a green and white flag is displayed for an incident, the protest committee will only protest a boat for an incident involving her that may have resulted in injury or serious damage, or if the protest committee learns during the hearing of a valid protest that the boat, although not a party to the hearing, was involved in the incident and may have broken a rule. This changes RRS 60.1 and 60.4(b).